



fellows fellowssc <fellows@science-corps.org>

New Science Corps Fellow Application: Rabelani Marikhele

1 message

Science Corps Web <eduversumdev@gmail.com>
To: fellows@science-corps.org

Tue, Jul 21, 2020 at 11:20 AM

Name

Rabelani Marikhele

Gender

Male

Nationality

South African

Emailmarikhele.r@gmail.com**When did or will you finish your PhD?**

December 2021

City, state, and country of residence

Limpopo Province South Africa

University education

PhD/Conservation Ecology/University of the Witwatersrand/2021
MSc/Invasion Biology/University of Venda/2018
BSc with Honours/Forestry/University of Venda/2013

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps Fellow? (max. 200 words)

I am applying for Science Corps Fellow because of their mission which is to expose PhD students to Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics (STEM) teaching experience. It has been my dream to give back what I have been learning to the next generation. Mostly in areas where it can be a challenge to get access to such knowledge, particularly in rural areas. I am motivated by my background and looking at how difficult it has been for me to further my studies. Being part of this fellow will grant me an opportunity to play a role in new scientific innovation and help in removing the stigma that black people/African do not study

biological sciences. I will also have a chance to participate in different workshops and learn more on different subjects. In the course of this experience, I will be able to design my own projects within STEM fellowship, and by doing so, new areas such as remote areas and Islands can be identified.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship (max. 200 words)

Over the past four years, I have been an undergraduate teaching assistant at the University of Witwatersrand in the school of Animal, Plant and Environmental Sciences. I assist with courses such as Invasion Biology, Plant Science, Conservation and Ecology. I have been involved in first-year classes with over 500 students, second and third-year classes with less than 100 students and supervising individual students. I am currently co-supervising an honours student from the University of Witwatersrand on the internal parasite of small carnivores. I have also been involved in organising and participating in a yearly science exhibition at the University of Witwatersrand titled 'Yebo Gogga'. I possess proficiency in several software programs, including Microsoft Office Suite (Word, Excel, Powerpoint, Emails), ArcGIS, and statistical analysis software such as STATA, SPSS, and R studio. I have strong interpersonal skills (excellent verbal and written communication skills, active listening, teamwork, flexible), as well as excellent administrative and leadership skills. I have proficiency in English, Isixhosa, Sesotho and Tshivenda Languages. In addition, I am currently learning French. I can work independently without supervision and I am willing to work across diverse African social and geographic boundaries.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Academic scientist in academia
Doing science in industry
In science education
In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (2 year) and long-term (10 year) future (max. 200 words)

As an emerging scientist, I hope to first develop myself academically by attaining a PhD in behavioural ecology in 2021. The results of my PhD studies, not only will they enhance knowledge on one of the least studied taxa in Africa, but will allow me to publish my work in various high impact journals, and disseminate knowledge in international and national conferences at large. My plan is to publish four papers on high impact journals in the next two years. I believe that not only will this help in disseminating scientific knowledge but will also help develop my research niche in behavioural ecology. I can, therefore, transfer my skills and knowledge to prospective students. This will help to achieve my long term plans in the next ten years which to have become academia, but also to be a vital and engaging member of any academic institution with more than 30 articles I find myself attached to. I will also be happy to have supervised three PhD students. I would love to at least secure funding over R500 000 and be involved in several international collaborations.

CV/Resumé

[Curriculum-Vitae-R-Marikhele.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

Some other mailing list

If other, please specify.

Graduate Student Network

Sent from Science Corps